FREE SAMPLER

10 starter recipes

The most popular recipes from the site, one printable page each, with a QR code to the full recipe.



Contents

Set up gradual wake-up lighting 3

Turn lights on with motion sensors 4

Turn lights off after motion stops 5

Turn lights on when a door opens 6

Dog-bark intrusion deterrent 7

Garage door left open alarm and alerts 8

Set a persistent cooking reminder 9

Fridge and freezer door alerts 10

Away mode automation for security 11

Smart home morning routine and scenes 12

How to use these cards

Each page is a short version of one web recipe. Page numbers are printed at the bottom of every card.

When is the trigger. **Only if** lists the conditions. **Do** is the action. **Stop** is what ends it.

Scan the QR code, or type the short link, for the full recipe with setup notes, failure modes, and device options.

Devices are examples of what fits the job, not requirements. Any device that does the same job and works with your hub is fine. Local options like Z-Wave, Zigbee, Matter over Thread, and HomeKit keep working when the internet is down.

Test every rule before you rely on it. Safety devices such as smoke, CO, and leak alarms must keep working without automation.

1 Set up gradual wake-up lighting

Wake up gently with a sunrise effect. Slowly brighten a bedroom light before your set wake time so mornings feel easier than a jarring alarm.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	A fixed time before the desired wake time, such as 30 minutes prior.
Only if	The day matches the intended schedule, such as weekdays only, and any vacation or skip setting is off.
Do	Set the light to a low starting brightness, then gradually raise it toward full brightness over the chosen duration.
Stop	The transition ends once it reaches full brightness, or is cancelled by a manual override.

Tip: Decide on the wake time and the transition length, then calculate the start time by subtracting the two, for example 6:00 AM start for a 6:30 AM wake time with a 30 minute transition.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/lighting/wake-up-lights.html

2 Turn lights on with motion sensors

Walk into a lit room without reaching for the switch. Turn lights on with motion while the wall switch keeps working for everyone in the house.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	The entry sensor changes from clear to motion detected.
Only if	The room is dark enough, or it is within the hours you want automatic light.
Do	Turn on the light. Use a dim level at night if the light supports it.
Stop	A manual wall-switch change should prevent the off recipe from undoing the person's choice.

Tip: Daytime: Leave the light off when daylight is sufficient.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/lighting/lights-on-motion.html

3 Turn lights off after motion stops

Stop paying to light empty rooms. Turn lights off after motion stops, with a forgiving timeout that respects people sitting still and wall switches.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	The room sensor reports no motion for the chosen timeout.
Only if	The light was turned on by this automation, no other room sensor is active, and no manual override is active.
Do	Turn the light off.
Stop	New motion, another active sensor, or a manual wall-switch change cancels the shutoff.

Tip: Quick access spaces: One to two minutes can work for a closet or hallway.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/lighting/lights-off-after-motion.html

4 Turn lights on when a door opens

Light closets, pantries, and utility rooms the moment the door opens, using a door sensor, while the regular wall switch still works.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	The contact sensor changes from closed to open.
Only if	The space is dark enough, or it is within the hours when automatic light makes sense.
Do	Turn on the light at the desired brightness.
Stop	A manual wall-switch change is an explicit choice and should not be immediately reversed.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/lighting/toggle-lights-door.html

SAFETY AND SECURITY

5 Dog-bark intrusion deterrent

Make an empty house sound guarded. Play a barking dog through a speaker when motion is detected while you are away, as an extra layer of deterrence.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	A motion sensor covering an entry point detects movement.
Only if	The home is in Away mode and, optionally, the time is within a defined nighttime window.
Do	Play a dog barking audio clip on a nearby speaker at a moderate volume, and send a notification.
Stop	A cooldown period, such as several minutes, prevents repeat playback from continued motion in the same area.

Tip: Confirm the platform can play a specific audio file or sound effect on the target speaker; test this manually before wiring it into an automation.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/security/fake-dog-deterrent.html

SAFETY AND SECURITY

6 Garage door left open alarm and alerts

Get a phone alert when the garage door is left open too long, plus a bedtime check. A simple open-door alarm that alerts only; closing stays manual.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	The garage door sensor reports "open" and stays in that state for a set duration, such as 10 minutes.
Only if	The door is still open at the time the duration elapses.
Do	Send a notification stating how long the door has been open.
Stop	The door being closed manually clears the alert.

Tip: Install a tilt sensor on the garage door, or confirm an existing smart garage controller already reports open and closed state to the platform.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/security/garage-door-notification.html

SAFETY AND SECURITY

7 Set a persistent cooking reminder

Stop worrying that the stove was left on. Keep a cooking reminder on screen until someone clears it, using a timer or approved appliance status.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	A person deliberately starts Cooking mode or an approved appliance signal reports active cooking.
Only if	Record which signal started the reminder. Do not require missing motion or Away mode.
Do	Start a visible timer and send a persistent reminder when the chosen interval expires.
Stop	A person checks the appliance controls and clears the reminder.

Tip: Put a physical timer or one-tap Cooking control next to the normal cooking workflow.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/security/stove-left-on-alert.html

APPLIANCE

8 Fridge and freezer door alerts

Save food when a fridge or freezer door is left ajar. Get an alert after a short delay, with a quicker one for the freezer and a check for missing data.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	The fridge or freezer door sensor reports open.
Only if	The sensor is available and reporting current data.
Do	Start a timer specific to that appliance.
Stop	The door closes before the delay elapses, which cancels the alert.

Tip: Mount the sensor body on the door frame and the magnet on the door edge, where the gap stays smallest when closed.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/appliances/fridge-door-alert.html

DAILY ROUTINE

9 Away mode automation for security

Leave without running through a checklist. Switch the home to Away once it is confirmed empty, then adjust lights, climate, and security for you.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	The last tracked household member leaves the home area.
Only if	Everyone has remained away for 10 to 15 minutes, Guest or Staying Home mode is off, and no recent indoor activity suggests someone remains.
Do	Set the shared house state to Away, turn off nonessential lights, apply a safe thermostat setback, and notify the household.
Stop	Someone returns, indoor activity appears during the delay, or a person selects Home, Guest, or Staying Home.

Tip: Create one shared state with at least Home, Away, and Guest values.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/daily-routines/away-mode.html

DAILY ROUTINE

10 Smart home morning routine and scenes

Start the day with lights only where you need them. A morning routine begins when you choose and leaves everyone still sleeping undisturbed.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	A person intentionally presses the morning button, uses the morning phrase, or dismisses a verified wake alarm.
Only if	The home is in Night mode, no Guest, Vacation, Away, or safety override is active, and the routine is enabled for that person or schedule.
Do	Change Night to Home, light only the needed route at a gentle level, and restore previously approved morning comfort settings.
Stop	The routine finishes after its one-time actions and cannot run again until the next Night-mode cycle.

Tip: Choose an intentional trigger that works without opening an app.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/daily-routines/morning-routine.html

51 more in the full set

You have the 10 most popular recipes. The full Recipe Cards PDF has all 61, one page each, with the same QR codes.

Lighting, security, climate, appliances, notifications, routines, and music. Print the ones you need and keep them by the hub.

Scan to see the full set

https://www.homeautomationcookbook.com/shop/

Every recipe also stays free to read on the site.